

Rep. Tom Emmer on The John Fredericks Show

JFRN

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HOST:

Join me now, Majority Whip, Tom Emmer, probably the most important person other than President Trump in America, because he continues to get things passed with a one-seat majority. I don't know how he does it. That is all whip work right there. I don't know how he does this. He's got one or two-seat majority, gets everything passed, and the things they don't want to get passed, well, they get deep-sixed, all because of Tom Emmer. Tom, thanks for being with us, Majority Whip.

REP. TOM EMMER:

With you, John. You're doing great work out there. Beat that stupid referendum. We got a hell of a shot to beat it. It's 50-50. It's going to be close, but we're gaining momentum at the end. Our voters are turning late. We need a big turnout, obviously, on Tuesday, but we got all hands on deck. We got a hell of a shot to beat it, Tom. All you need is for Timmy Wall's address, Abigail Spanberger, to start flapping her gums again, and that'll help you a lot, I think.

HOST:

Before we get into politics, the Minnesota Twins, your baseball team, did what I complimented them as a real fire sale, a real rebuild, got rid of all their veterans, got young players in, total rebuild, got to do it the right way. They didn't. They didn't do it halfway. I commended them when they did it. I figured, okay, so you've got a couple of seasons of pain. I turned around there in first place. You're a Texas Rangers fan, and you're a Houston Astros fan, and you're celebrating the fact that the Minnesota Twins, one of your best farm teams over the last decade, unloaded almost a third of their team overnight and all of their pitching talent, and all of a sudden they've cobbled together like an amazing ... I mean, they've won 8 out of 10. I don't know that this continues all year, but if you look at these pitchers, John, Taj Bradley, all of a sudden he's showing that he might be an all-star if he can keep this kind of pace up, and this new kid, Abel, this kid, my goodness, watch him. He's a tall, skinny drink of water, but when he throws the ball, it moves all over the place.

REP. TOM EMMER:

So who knows? Minnesota is an interesting place. As you know, we do have two World Series titles. It's the only thing we've ever won there. Well, I tell you what, what's great about it is when you get young kids up and a couple of grizzled veterans like Taj Bradley, who's bounced around from Tampa Bay and here and there and just never ... always had the talent, but he never really connected. But they've cobbled together this team, but they've got all these young players that last season were in AAA or AA, and they're all up there having fun. And when you have fun, you win games. That's kind of the way baseball is. You have fun, you win games, you're playing very well, and they're a fun young team to watch. But you've got a few veterans. And the one thing that the ownership did is they kept your ace, Joe Ryan, they kept him. And of course, he's anchoring the staff as always, but it's a fun team to watch.

HOST:

Well, and Buxton. Don't forget they kept Buxton, and then they kept Royce Lewis. So if Royce Lewis could keep himself on the field for a full season, I just can't imagine what that young man's going to do. So we're going to have a lot of fun this summer, John. We're going to have a lot of fun.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, you guys are in first place, and my Astros are in last place. So it's like you gave up before your players, and we're in the cellar, and you guys are in first place. Somehow I got a feeling that ain't going to last, but we'll see. We got so many injuries going on. Okay, let's ... Speaking of injuries.

HOST:

Let's talk about the tax day yesterday. I mean, it was just, I was, that press conference, I thought it was just a great day. I thought Scott Besson was wonderful. I'm a big fan of Kelly's, obviously everybody knows that. She's been on my show a hundred times. I backed her when she ran for U.S. Senate, and just a great lady. But you look at the money that people are saving, how does this not resonate into November votes?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, now you're getting under my skin, and I'll tell you why in a second, because you're right. The big, beautiful tax cut bill, as the president referred to it yesterday, which we are now calling the Working Families Tax Cuts bill, a family of four with two kids, John, earning up to \$73,000 in this country, will have no federal income tax liability. That is why it's the Working Families Tax Cut Act. Not only are these cuts putting more money back in the pockets of hardworking Americans, more than 7 million jobs have been protected or created as well. Had Congress failed to save the 2017 Trump tax cuts, we'd have had a \$1.1 trillion shortfall in the U.S. GDP, a loss of 5.9 million jobs, and taxes would have gone up 22%. And I can't emphasize enough, not one Democrat voted to support the Working Families Tax Cut Act. It's incredible. We did that. Republicans with Donald Trump are the ones that did that, and people, you're right, are starting to feel it now. But here's why you're getting under my skin, because I've got a worthless, incompetent, and perhaps very corrupt governor by the name of Timmy Walls in Minnesota, who has refused to pass tax compliance legislation. So guess what? Minnesotans like me do not get the full benefit of the federal tax savings.

HOST:

This should be emphasized all over the place. Colorado went over, tried to override the no taxes on tips, override the no taxes on tips. These blue states are the most mismanaged, corrupt states, and people gotta wake up and start exercising their right to vote with intelligence. They gotta start voting for people that actually care about them instead of their own power.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, Majority Whip, remember, we got the same thing going on where I live here in Washington, D.C., where our city council and governor really didn't take a position on it, our current mayor, but our city council said, no, we're not gonna codify any of the one big, beautiful bill, 8.5% tax, tax on tips, tax on overtime, Social Security, nothing, you're not getting anything. And then the House of Representatives, under your leadership, overruled them because you have that right, and said, no, you're going to give people the one big, beautiful bill. You got it to the Senate, which also voted for giving us the one big, beautiful bill for state taxes, because we're like a state here. And then the council said, well, no, we're simply not gonna do it. And the Senate was 13 hours behind in passing it, and so now we're going to screw all of our workers over 13 hours, and now it's in the hands of some

judge. What is the deal with this? What is going on here?

HOST:

Well, it's a, really, they do not want us to be successful. They recognize that yesterday was the actual beginning. Look, John, you know, over the first year of this Trump presidency, there has been more accomplished than perhaps in the decade preceding, or decades preceding. It is amazing what this president and this Republican Congress has been able to do. But all the good news, we've got a corrupt press, present company excluded, we've got a corrupt press that's out there constantly singing all the negatives, trying to downplay all the good things that are happening. So as our friend Steve Moore would tell us, perception and reality are two different things. The reality is, amazing things are happening in our economy in spite of the Iran mission, in spite of the current hiccup that's taking place, for good reason. Because we've got a president who finally is putting the safety and security of Americans and American soldiers first, right? He'll get this done, and you'll see that readjust very quickly. But in spite of all that, mortgages at a six-year low, I think it was, recently, you had gas prices are still below where they were at the high under Joe Biden, and the Hormuz Straits are blockaded. So you have all this good news, but guess what? Perception has not met reality yet. Yesterday, I believe, was the absolute beginning of that reality coming home. It's how you feel about your situation. And now that the average family, the average return was \$3,400. You know, those of us that live in blue states where they won't comply, we're not getting that kind of a return. But where the Republican tax cuts, where the Trump tax cuts are actually being felt, working families in this country have an average of \$3,400, and some more than that, because that's the average that they're getting back on their taxes this year. John, that's real money. That's life-changing dollars. For some of these people, that'll pay their energy costs for the year. Some of them, it'll pay their rent for the year. This is important stuff. And now, perception is going to start to head towards the reality. And we just need those two intersecting by the time we get to August and September. So people, this is why Democrats, they don't want this to happen, because they know this is the key to winning the midterms.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I think you're right. And if you look at small businesses, the average tax saving of any small business under this bill was \$7,000. I mean, that is a lot of money. We saved enough money in our company that we're now looking at buying another radio property, which we were not prior to this, because we're kind of topped out, and a lot of things we're doing. But now you get the benefit of the one-year write-off, and so it makes sense to make an investment and hire people. Yeah.

HOST:

No, and that's what's coming to the economy. So what I'm talking about yesterday is the actual returns. More than half the filers are claiming things like no taxes on tips, no taxes on overtime, no taxes on Social Security. Those are things they're feeling today. But what you just talked about, your investment, potential investment in the economy, is what we're seeing everywhere. This 100% expensing, you've got billions of dollars being invested back into the U.S. economy to reshore manufacturing, create new opportunities for everyone all across this country. And as that continues to take hold, that's what I'm talking about. When perception meets reality as we come towards the end of the summer and in the fall, we're going to do well in the midterms. I'm tired of people telling me how bad it is today. We've never lost an election in April, John.

REP. TOM EMMER:

You're right. It's kind of like baseball. You're not going to win the division or lose a division in April, right? So very early. We'll see what happens. But I agree with that. And I was telling Dan Oxler, I know he's going to be in your office, friend of mine, next week. So I'm going to be entertaining him here in D.C. But the YouGov poll only

has the Republicans in the generic poll down by five. All this bad news, all this fake news, anti-Trump, anti-Trump every day, never stops, started the press briefing again yesterday, all gotcha questions from the libtards, and you're only down by five. Why aren't you down by ten?

HOST:

Well, first off, I'm not a big fan of the generic. The generic oversamples Democrats regularly. We've always said, you know, if it's within five points, it means it's dead even, which, OK, we can we can talk that way or we can look at it and say we got 435. Pieces of ground here in the house, pieces of geography, each piece of geography has unique demographics. You've got to have the right candidate, you've got to have the right message and you've got to have enough money to get that message to the voters, to motivate them, engage them and motivate them to come out and make the purchase, to cast a vote. And you know what? I think the message that we have, we're putting Americans first. This is the Make America Great Again movement on steroids. We are putting their security first. We're putting their health first. We're putting everything about America first. And you know what? What are Democrats doing? One, they don't have a leader and two, hey, we hate Donald Trump and you should, too. The only thing that I'm concerned about is we all better recognize those of us who love this country and know that if we had not been successful with Donald Trump in 2024, we would not have this country today. We better recognize that that violent, hardcore left is about as agitated and aggravated as it has ever been. It is like a cornered, rabid animal. It understands it's on its last days. It is going to claw and bite and snarl and do anything it can to stay in this thing till the end. And the only way we can make sure we put this down once and for all is by showing up and voting. And you guys are doing it right now in Virginia with this crooked referendum that you got to deal with. And I think you're going to get it done.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I tell you what, if we beat this thing on April 21st, which we had no chance to do about six weeks ago, zero chance. But as I go around on my bus tour, the enthusiasm has exceeded my expectations for voting. No, we're getting a lot of Democrats that are voting, you know, that just think this thing is so egregious. But look, the stakes are high because if we lose this, you're going to lose four seats. And then the math for you guys keeping the house becomes really, really narrow. It becomes very close. But here's what my faith is in, John, and you're proving it in Virginia. Americans, regardless of their political persuasion, unless you are a radical, you know, anarchist, communist, Marxist, you know, you're never going to listen to anything. Republicans, whether they're on the left of center or the right of center, they don't like to be purposely misled, resent being lied to. Just look at what Abigail Spanberger ran on and what she actually is doing when she's in office. And she literally is pissing off every Virginian who supported her because she lied to them. She effectively lied to get into office. It's the same thing with this referendum. The more people learn about how they are being misled and somebody is trying to fool them. I don't care what their political persuasion is, John. People do not appreciate that. Americans believe in one thing, and I believe this in my core. We believe in fairness at the end of the day. That's why we, you know, somebody we can't stand someday. You've all said it, boy, I never thought I'd say this, but I really feel sorry for that guy. Right. Right. I believe in fairness and I think fairness is going to prevail in Virginia. And I think fairness is going to prevail in the elections in November.

HOST:

Well, what's interesting is Hakeem Jeffries, who wants to be speaker, has so far, get this, of what we know, dumped \$57 million into Virginia to pass this referendum, \$57 million. My body, they can't move the needle. They're stuck at like 47%. And they changed their message. But what's interesting is when they first started, the message was, hey, vote yes, stop Trump. Now what's happening is we got Democrats saying and independents vote no to send Spanberger a message. So the thing is flipped in two months.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, first off, let's just acknowledge that Hakeem Jeffries is not a leader. I wouldn't follow that guy through a buffet line. I mean, this guy is not a leader. We're very fortunate that he's the guy that they have entrusted with their checkbook, because if anybody can screw this up that day, that goofball is going to screw this up. So God bless him. I hope he burns all these bags of money in the street and I hope you make him pay for it.

HOST:

All right. We got to bring in. I know you have to go, but we got to talk hockey. But let me just bring in one of your colleagues, Aaron Houchen, is with us. Let's bring Aaron in. Aaron, you're on with Congresswoman Houchen. You're great. We're doing a remake of Beauty and the Beast.

REP. AARON HOUCHEN:

I really appreciate it, John. Whip Tom Emmer, he says he's one of your fans.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, I'm a huge fan of our whip, Tom Emmer, and I was just cracking up at not following Hakeem Jeffries through a buffet line. That is classic Tom Emmer. That is the Tom Emmer that we all know and love. And he's on a roll this morning. I love it.

HOST:

OK, so Tom's got to go because he's got to like whip stuff. But there's a lot to whip. That's for sure. But before we do that, Tom, we got to get to hockey. You know, I'm a hockey fan and I'm just going to make a prediction for that. And I got a column coming out on the playoffs. You know who the most dangerous team is in my judgment? That nobody wants to play the Minnesota Wild. That's the most dangerous team in hockey, because on any given night they can score. They got a good goalie. They play defense. They've got depth in their lines. They're they're very tough at home. Nobody wants to play the wild, Tom.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I will say this, John, because I agree. But they got to get through the first round. If they get through the first round against Dallas, look out. That team will grow in their confidence and they have every tool they need to go all through the final thing. But the beauty of this is, and I think you'll agree, there is no definitive leader this year. I mean, it's been the Florida Panthers for two of the last three years that they were the definitive. You had to climb the mountain with them. And it was the Oilers with McDavid, et cetera. If they would have had goaltending, they probably would have had a cup by now. But guess what? This time, a whole bunch of teams that have a chance to get their Montreal should scare people. Montreal could be the first team to win a cup from Canada since 1993. And Carolina, I'm sorry to Carolina, the hurricane nation. But what a great team. I just got a feeling they're going to disappoint all you again. You're going to be like a Vikings fan. We almost got there. We almost made it. It's going to be fun, whatever happens, John. But I do agree. If Minnesota gets on a roll, the three best teams are in the West. It's Colorado, Dallas and Minnesota. But you've got some really interesting teams. Anaheim's kind of taken a dive at the end of the year, but they've got some really interesting talent that mix. And then over in the east, that Buffalo team, we better not count them out before this thing gets going.

HOST:

Don't break your heart, though, too. Well, yeah, and I agree with you on the Canadians, too, because they're young, they're fast, they play with reckless abandon. They're a bunch of 19 year olds. They don't know like

they're not supposed to be winning games. They're supposed to be in a rebuild. And remember, they got Caulfield, who happens to be an American.

REP. TOM EMMER:

That's right. They do have Caulfield. But here you go. It won't be an Indiana hockey team.

REP. AARON HOUCHEN:

Don't be so selfish, Aaron. You got enough this year. I know you got this.

HOST:

But here's why I bet the wild to win the cup. Right. And I took I took a very, very decent odds on him. Here's why better, because if they beat Dallas in the first round, they're going to win the cup. I mean, so you want to get it over with. I think the best thing people that say, oh, well, they got to play Dallas. You know, it's a tough draw. I think it's the best thing that happened to them because if they can somehow beat the stars, they're going to win.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, they can beat the stars. They can beat them. I know those teams are those teams are very evenly matched, a little different, but very evenly matched. And I'd rather see him play him in the first round than, you know, in the second or the third round if you got a little a little bit of tired legs because Dallas has depth. Well, that's black and blue. That's my that's my that's my take. I also agree with you on Carolina. They'll choke again. So we'll see what happens. But maybe they'll move to Indiana.

HOST:

You ever been a game in Raleigh? I mean, you stand every game is standing room only because I live there is an amazing fan base.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Oh, they came. They call them the Caniacs. Like, yeah, the Caniacs, they're they're they're fun. So we'll see what happens. It all starts. It all starts, I think, on Tuesday night. And a lot of teams that could be shockers, Sabres, one of them, Montreal. You just don't know what's going to happen. So don't count the Bruins out either. Don't count on Tampa Bay.

HOST:

Yeah, I mean, it's it's wide open. And boy, the NHL has done it right. Yeah. Salad Cup is right. The playoff. The only thing I don't like, Tom, is I don't like the I don't like that. You get a you get one point in overtime either way. I don't like that. I think not now. Not now.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah. Now that all the marbles. And by the way, I just have a sneaky suspicion you won't have a Stanley Cup final where Bad Bunny is going to be performing anywhere. Just just throw that out there. Just think again.

HOST:

Well, the NHL's got it, got it right. There's there's no things on the ice that piss people off. None of that that doesn't exist. Like 90, half the teams don't even have it. So it's just hockey. It's just like you turn the hockey game. I don't want to watch hockey. I get politics all day. Not interested. Right. So there you have it. So we'll

see what happens. Aaron, sorry, we had to do all this hockey stuff with you.

REP. AARON HOUCHEN:

Well, I got to tell you, last time I was on, you said, John, that there wasn't a topic that you thought I couldn't tackle. But hockey is definitely that topic. Liar. Liar. I know nothing about hockey.

HOST:

Yeah, you can fake it pretty good. The other team that's going to that I believe is going to win their first round is the Penguins. Nobody nobody saw them either. They were in another rebuild. And I think the Penguins win their first round. A lot of fun. We're going to have a lot of fun. We'll talk about it again, John.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Oh, yeah, we'll have you on now. Now you now you've got to get rid of the fluff talk and go and talk to the policy wonk in the the leadership wonk here and how great to see you, Tom. I'll see you later.

HOST:

You will see me later. Thanks, John. Good luck with that referendum. Let's knock that thing out. Thank you. Thank you. Tom, you want to follow the majority of the whip. Just go to [Emmer.House.Gov](https://emmer.house.gov). [Emmer.House.Gov](https://emmer.house.gov). Tom, thank you. Thanks for being here.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you. Have a great day. I don't see any transcript segment provided in your message. You've given me the speaker labels to use (HOST, REP. AARON HOUCHEN, REP. TOM EMMER) and clear instructions, but the actual transcript content appears to be missing. Could you please provide the transcript segment that needs speaker labels added? Once you share the text, I'll be happy to add the appropriate speaker labels while preserving all the original content exactly as specified.

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